service providers (ISPs) soon added their resources to the network. At the end of the decade, Tim Berners-Lee, working at CERN, invented nothing less than the World Wide Web.

During this prolific decade, the luxurious problem of distributed computing emerged in the enterprise. Companies of all types were faced with the possibility of connecting multiple applications across the network to create larger applications. To stay competitive, they decided to multiply the value of their data.

In the early 1990s, more middleware ideas emerged. Common Object Request Broker Architecture (CORBA) and its commercial counterpart, the Distributed Component Object Model (DCOM), became representatives of middleware for remote procedure calls (RPCs), both specifications that define how objects can interact between programs on different computers.

In the early 2000s, the idea behind middleware became known as enterprise application integration (EAI). As David S. Linthicum put it, “It is, at its foundation, a response to decades of creating distributed monolithic, single-purpose applications” (*Enterprise Application Integration*, Addison-Wesley Professional, 2003). Different applications ran on different systems—mainframes, UNIX servers, NT servers—and they needed each other. They benefited from cross-pollination

In the same spirit, the Web Services specification was launched in 2002. The RPC solutions of that time were inadequate because, among other things, communication was mostly only allowed via HTTP, and CORBA communicates via TCP/IP. Even more fundamental, however, is the fallible nature of network communications. In their abstraction, RPC interfaces did not contain